



Your Questions, Our Answers

All your computing niggles and nags are dealt with here!

Running Out Of Memory On Windows Vista

Q I have an Intel Pentium 4 2.93 GHz, 1 GB DDR2 RAM, 80 GB 7200 RPM HDD and an Intel 945 motherboard. I am using Vista Ultimate with SP1 installed and it is regularly updated. Whenever I



Whoops! Vista's hogging memory again

launch two or more applications I get low memory error. I have even turned of aero. But it has not even helped. Please tell how to reduce vista memory usage.

Rahul Choudhary

A The problem of memory shortage could be to do with the pagefile especially because you are running Vista on 1 GB of memory which is the bare minimum. Check the page file settings for your system by starting up the System properties. Click on the Advanced tab and click on Settings under Performance. Again, click on Advanced and click the Change button under the Virtual memory section. Here, set a size for the page file if there isn't one set already.

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@thinkdigit.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

Loads Of user32.dll And shell32.dll Errors

Q I have an AMD Athlon 64 processor with 1 GB of RAM and an 80 GB HDD with Windows XP SP2. I am facing a problem of user32.dll. When I was trying to install pc suite for my mobile, I got some errors relating to use32.dll. Also I can't access the calculator application in Windows. Everytime I try to open CALC from Start > Run, it gives me a similar error. Both the errors are same. I have got these errors before as well so I have reinstalled Windows but problem still remains. Also while reinstalling the windows, first time I got a blue screen. The next time it installed properly. Can you please advise me on this issue? Sometimes my pc suddenly restarts randomly.

Pratish



Nagging dll errors

A The user32.dll and shell32.dll errors suggest that those files have been tampered with. Your screenshots you've sent have some modifications done to the operating system. This could be some kind of desktop replacement or interface theme software to change to look of your operating system. Even after you reinstalled Windows, you might have reinstalled this software. Try uninstalling these software properly and see if the error stops. If it doesn't work, then the files have been corrupted and you might have to repair them by reinstalling Windows or by using the recovery mode while booting off the XP CD.

Poor Performance In Games... Should I Overclock?

Q My PC configuration: Motherboard: Intel 945GC- M7 TE; Processor: Intel Celeron 1.80 GHz; RAM: 512 DDR2 Recently, I bought a NVIDIA XFX GeForce 8400GS 512 MB graphics card. But I haven't got the desired performance from it. I cannot run games like *NFS: Most Wanted* and *NFS: Carbon* beyond the resolution of 800 x 600 with a few settings in medium. The games slow down. Even *F.E.A.R.* with resolution 640 x 480 with settings like anti-aliasing at 2x and medium shadow quality give around 40 fps. Please tell me what should I do to get good performance out of it? I have heard that over-clocking

Installing XP Over Vista

Q I'm in the National Institute Of Technology, Karnataka. I am using a Sony Vaio laptop VGN-FZ410E. It has a 250 GB SATA hard disk and the RAM on it is 2 GB DDR2. I use Windows Vista Home Basic which came with the laptop. Now, I want to install Windows XP on it. Please guide me.

Siva Kumar

A To install Windows XP, first you need an empty partition. If you don't have one, use Computer Management to resize the existing partition and make space for a new one. Under the Disk Management application, right click on the partition and click on Shrink Volume. Choose the space you want free after the shrinking process. Change the drive letter of your CD/DVD drive to avoid any confusion by right-clicking on the drive and then clicking Change drive Letter and Paths. Now right-click on the empty space created and click on New Simple Volume and create the partition with the right drive letter. Boot using the XP installation CD and install it. You will then no longer be able to boot into Windows Vista. Boot into XP and install a software called VistaBootPRO from www.vistabootpro.org which will allow you to make entries and changes to the boot record.

a graphics card boosts its performance. Should I over-clock my card? I have no idea how to do that. Please explain its procedure.

Parzan

A The 8400GS is an entry level graphics card and the processor you are using is also very outdated. Overclocking the card would only bring a marginal improvement. Besides, there's a bigger risk involved which means you could damage the card and the processor if you overclock it. A better processor would probably add an average 10 to 15 fps more to the performance but a completely new system is highly recommended if you wish to play all these games with all the details and resolution turned up.

Random Lockups

Q I am using a Pentium IV computer which I assembled in 2004. Since then it was working fine. But since last week it is giving me headache.

My PC configuration is 845 GVSr Intel motherboard with an Intel Pentium 4 Processor 2.4 GHz 256 MB DDR SDRAM DVD/CD-RW Combo Drive CD-Rom Drive 1.44 floppy Hard Disk - 40 GB PATA Internet - DataOne Broadband with 2Mbps speed Antivirus - Avast Home Edition updated every day. Since the last four years it was working fine. Now there are a few problems -

1. Sometimes, it hangs and then restarts automatically
2. Sometimes after hanging for a few seconds gives an error that the display driver has stopped working normally. To work properly, I must restart the computer.

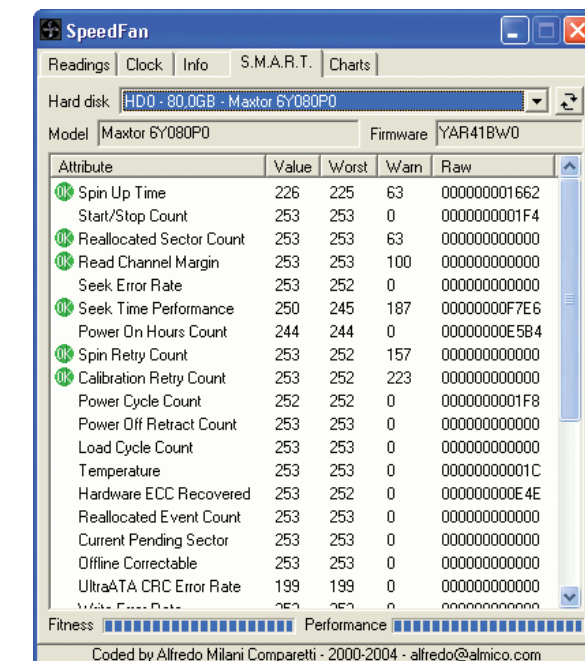


VistaBootPro can help in fixing records for booting into Vista

3. Sometimes, it gives a boot disk error and a press any key to start error. Thanks

Avinash Kumar

A The instability you are facing could be because of a faulty hard drive. Your 40 GB hard drive has last a long time. Run some diagnostic tools to verify if the hard drive is indeed failing. Backup any important data onto other drives or discs. Try a software called Speedfan which has a hard drive health utility. You can



Speedfan also has a hard drive health checking feature